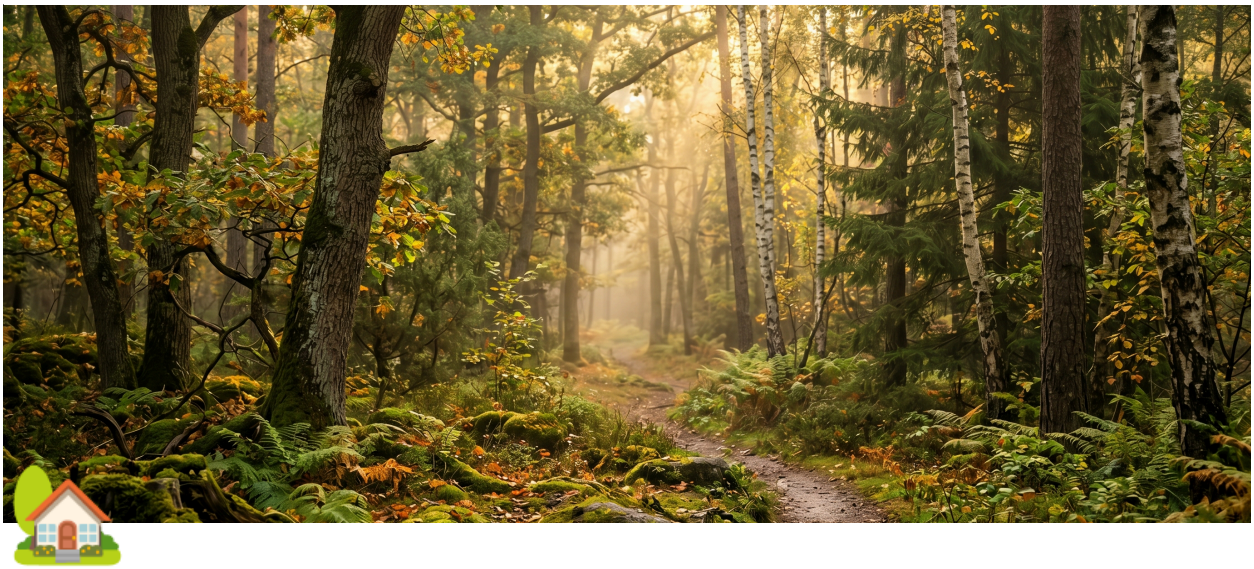


HomeOwnership Strategy Refresh 2026

Group: *Home Ownership* | **Collective:** *Borrowing*

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👀 How to read this report

- 🧠 **If you weren't in the workshop:** Start from **Context;** read from the top. This will give you the background, customer need themes, and opportunity areas before moving into the workshop outcomes and recommendations.
- 🚀 **If you were in the workshop:** You can start from **Synthesised Themes from Ideation**. This section summarises the strategic direction, key insights, product pillars, and recommended next steps that came out of the session.
- 📚 **Use the Appendix as a reference bank:** It contains the key assumptions and all brainstorm ideas from the workshop, grouped by journey stage. These

have been included so they can be easily accessed later and used by Notion AI as future reference material.

Summary

Key Stakeholders across Home Ownership conducted a **half-day workshop** t**o align on our strategic focus** and explore how we can differentiate more clearly in the market.

Outcome: The strategic bet is to **build the first truly managed homebuying experience for First-Time Buyers** which combines mortgage, guidance, coordination, documents, payments, and decision support into one Monzo-owned journey.

The differentiator is not that Monzo offers more services. It is that **Monzo helps customers know what to do, when to do it, who is responsible, what it means, and whether everything is on track**.

This gives the Project Manager proposition a clear purpose: **reduce the cognitive, emotional, and coordination burden of buying a home**. The workshop ideation suggests this should be delivered through an integrated experience that gives customers clarity, confidence, momentum, and control across the full journey.

The main themes identified from ideation were:

1. **Customers need a journey command centre, not disconnected tools.**
    - *Strategic implication:* We should create a single source of truth for progress, next steps, responsibilities, key dates, blockers, and upcoming decisions.
2. **FTBs need confidence before they need commitment.**
    - *Strategic implication*: We should support customers earlier in the journey with affordability, readiness, scenario planning, education, and Mortgage in Principle guidance before they reach formal application.
3. **The biggest pain is coordination across third parties.**
    - *Strategic implication:* 'Project Manager' needs to mean active coordination, not just information display, including stakeholder ownership, chasing, shared visibility, and escalation routes.

4. **Decision support is as important as process support.**
    - *Strategic implication:* Monzo can differentiate by becoming the customer's translator and decision companion, helping them understand trade-offs, risks, survey/legal issues, offer decisions, and next steps.
5. **Documents, data, and payments are hygiene needs, but also trust builders.**
    - *Strategic implication:* Monzo has a strong right to win by making sensitive data sharing, document handling, source-of-funds checks, solicitor bank verification, and large payments feel safe and controlled.
6. **Emotional reassurance is a strategic feature, not a nice-to-have.**
    - *Strategic implication:* The experience should deliberately design for anxiety, uncertainty, and high-stress moments through proactive check-ins, reassurance, escalation, and human support when needed.

Next steps

1. Create a 6–12 month product execution roadmap.
2. Define partner and operating model requirements.
3. Prioritise opportunities and create MVP/stretch/big vision concepts.
4. Research the concepts with FTB customers.
5. Define the Project Manager proposition.

Context

Key Stakeholders across Home Ownership conducted a **half-day workshop** that was designed **to align on our strategic focus** and explore how we can differentiate more clearly in the market.

We centred on two key areas: **supporting First-Time Buyers** (FTBs), and developing a **strong 'Project Manager' proposition**. FTBs represent an opportunity for improved acquisition and retention, while the Project Manager concept is our primary differentiator — with other elements (such as Multiplayer and Async Advisor) supporting this core idea.

The goal of the session was to define what “Project Manager” could mean in an ambitious, future-facing way, without immediate constraints.

The workshop focused on:

- Identifying key user pain points and themes
- Generating a wide range of potential solutions
- Mapping and prioritising ideas across the customer journey



This work forms the foundation for shaping future product direction, including defining opportunities, validating them with users, and informing our roadmap and messaging.

Customer Themes & Opportunity Areas

To ground our direction in real user needs, we reviewed First-Time Buyer (FTB) research to identify recurring pain points across the homebuying journey, with a particular focus on project management.

A clear insight emerged: one of the biggest challenges is not any single task, but the need for customers to manage the whole process themselves. Buyers are often left coordinating multiple stakeholders, navigating fragmented communication, and keeping track of scattered information, documents, and costs.

This highlighted the need to improve three things across the journey:

- **Coordination** between the different people and organisations involved
- **Visibility** of progress, responsibilities, and next steps
- **Coherence** across information, communication, documents, and costs

From this analysis, we developed a set of core themes that capture the most significant challenges customers face when managing their purchase.

💡 These themes act as guideposts for the workshop and future work. They help us frame the problem space, align around user needs, and focus solution ideation on the areas with the greatest potential impact.

The Themes

🥵 1. The "What's Next?" Anxiety (Status & Step Tracking)

- Buyers often describe the process as a "maze," with little clarity on what stage they are at or what comes next.
- *Opportunity:* Provide clear step-by-step guidance, progress tracking, and visibility of upcoming milestones and timelines.

📣 2. The Stakeholder Maze (Chasing & Communication Management)

- A lack of coordination between solicitors, brokers, and agents forces buyers into the role of middleman.
- *Opportunity:* Centralise communication, track responsibilities, and reduce manual chasing through shared visibility and automation.

🪨 3. Translating Roadblocks (Issue Resolution)

- When issues arise (e.g. survey results or legal flags), buyers lack the context to assess severity or know how to respond.
- *Opportunity:* Translate complex information, clarify impact, and guide users with actionable next steps.

🗂️ 4. The Paperwork Burden (Document Management)

- The volume of paperwork and repetitive back-and-forth is a major source of frustration.
- *Opportunity:* Simplify document handling through a centralised, easy-to-use hub.

🔒 5. The Secure Hub (Data & Privacy Confidence)

- Sharing sensitive financial information across multiple parties leaves buyers feeling exposed and vulnerable.

- *Opportunity:* Create a trusted, transparent system with clear permissions, secure data handling, and reassurance around how information is shared.

🧠 **6. The Knowledge Gap (Contextual Education)**

- Many buyers feel underprepared, lacking basic knowledge of the process, terminology, and financial implications.
- *Opportunity:* Deliver timely, contextual education — from jargon translation to guidance on schemes, costs, and decisions.

💸 **7. Just-In-Time Cashflow (Financial Preparation)**

- Buyers are anxious about managing large, time-sensitive payments and avoiding unexpected costs.
- *Opportunity:* Link financial tools to the journey, ensuring funds are available and actionable at the right moments.

Synthesised Themes from Ideation

> 💡 Following the workshop, all ideas generated during the brainstorm were reviewed and synthesised to identify common patterns and recurring opportunity areas. The themes below represent a consolidation of those ideas. They are intended to simplify a wide range of inputs into a clearer set of directions to guide next steps.

Across every stage of the journey, the same need appears repeatedly: customers do not just need a mortgage, conveyancer, calculator, or document store. They need help **understanding, coordinating, tracking, and making decisions across the whole process**. The workshop ideation shows that the **highest-value opportunity is not a single feature, but an integrated experience** that gives customers clarity, confidence, and momentum from early preparation through completion and beyond.[1]

The “Project Manager” proposition should therefore be framed around three core jobs:

1. **Make the process understandable**

Explain what is happening, what matters, what decisions need to be made, and what the customer should do next.

2. **Make the process coordinated**

   Bring together advisors, solicitors, lenders, estate agents, documents, payments, and milestones into one managed journey.

3. **Make the process feel safe and under control**

   Reduce anxiety around uncertainty, large payments, sensitive data, delays, roadblocks, and moments where customers do not know who to trust.

For FTBs, this is especially powerful because they often lack prior experience, have lower confidence, and are more likely to value an all-in-one guided experience.

Main themes and insights

1. Customers need a “journey command centre”, not a set of disconnected tools

Across the workshop, there are repeated ideas around progress trackers, timelines, checklists, stage-by-stage guidance, next-step prompts, document hubs, saved properties, offer tracking, and completion visibility.

Insight: The core unmet need is visibility across the whole journey. Customers want to know:

- Where am I?
- What happens next?
- Who is responsible?
- What should I be doing now?
- What could delay me?
- What decisions are coming up?

Strategic implication: The Project Manager proposition should start with a central homebuying dashboard that becomes the customer’s single source of truth.

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2. FTBs need confidence before they need commitment

The early-stage ideas focus heavily on affordability, education, scenario planning, financial readiness, process explainers, and early expert support.

Insight: FTBs are not simply trying to get a mortgage. They are trying to work out whether they are ready, what they can afford, what trade-offs they can make, and whether they are making a sensible decision.

Strategic implication: Monzo should help customers enter the market with confidence before they reach the formal mortgage application stage. This could become a major acquisition lever.

Potential focus areas:

- Affordability and total cost calculator
- Deposit and savings readiness
- Scenario planning
- “Can I afford this property?” checks
- Step-by-step FTB education
- Early advisor call or automated guidance
- Mortgage in Principle as a confidence-building milestone

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3. The biggest pain is coordination across third parties

The workshop repeatedly surfaced the frustration of coordinating solicitors, lenders, brokers, estate agents, surveyors, removal services, insurers, and other stakeholders.

Insight: Customers are forced to act as the middleman in a process they do not fully understand. This creates anxiety, delays, duplicated effort, and a sense that nobody is truly in charge.

Strategic implication: “Project Manager” should mean more than showing information. It should mean actively helping the customer coordinate the process.

Potential focus areas:

- Clear ownership of tasks across stakeholders

- Automated chasing and reminders
- Shared visibility of progress
- Escalation routes when something stalls
- Support for solicitors or other parties who are not fully integrated
- Human support at high-stress points

This is likely the clearest differentiator versus a conventional mortgage journey.

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4. Decision support is as important as process support

Several stages include ideas around AI-powered property insights, offer guidance, survey/search result translation, cost trade-offs, “what should I ask?”, and contextual reassurance.

Insight: Customers do not just need to complete tasks. They need help interpreting information and making decisions under uncertainty.

This is particularly true for FTBs, who may not know:

- Whether a survey issue is serious
- Whether to renegotiate
- Whether to stretch their budget
- Whether a property is a good fit
- What an offer should look like
- Whether delays or issues are normal

Strategic implication: Monzo can differentiate by becoming the customer’s translator and decision companion, not just their broker.

Potential focus areas:

- Plain-English explanations of legal, mortgage, survey, and property information
- “What this means for you” summaries
- Suggested next steps
- Suggested questions to ask third parties

- Benchmarks or reassurance on how common issues are
- Escalation to human support for complex or high-risk moments

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5. Documents, data, and payments are hygiene needs — but also trust builders

The workshop ideation contained repeated references to document hubs, secure sharing, one-time data collection, bank statement sharing, solicitor bank detail verification, transfer support, and fraud prevention.

Insight: Document and payment management may sound operational, but they are deeply emotional moments because they involve sensitive information and large sums of money.

Strategic implication: Monzo has a credible right to win here because trust, money movement, security, and customer-friendly financial UX are already part of the brand.

Potential focus areas:

- Centralised document hub
- Secure permission-based sharing
- Reusable property/home passport
- Source-of-funds support
- Verified solicitor bank details
- Guided deposit transfer flow
- Payment timing and cashflow reminders
- Fraud education at key moments

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6. Emotional reassurance is a strategic feature, not a nice-to-have

The ideas from the workshop repeatedly mention stress, uncertainty, reassurance, “SOS” support, check-ins, celebration, post-completion follow-ups, and moments of doubt.

Insight: Homebuying is not just complex; it is emotionally volatile. Customers need reassurance at moments where they feel exposed, uncertain, or afraid of making an expensive mistake.

Strategic implication: The Project Manager proposition should deliberately design for emotional states, not just functional tasks.

Potential focus areas:

- Proactive check-ins
- “Everything is on track” reassurance
- Clear escalation routes
- Human support at moments of high anxiety
- Completion-day visibility
- Celebration and closure at the end of the journey

🚀 Recommended strategic focus

The strategic bet is:

> **Build the first truly managed homebuying experience for First-Time Buyers — combining mortgage, guidance, coordination, documents, payments, and decision support into one Monzo-owned journey.**

The differentiator is not “we offer more services”. It is:

> **Monzo helps customers know what to do, when to do it, who is responsible, what it means, and whether everything is on track.**

That gives the Project Manager proposition a clear purpose: **reduce the cognitive, emotional, and coordination burden of buying a home.**

Suggested next steps

1. Define the Project Manager proposition clearly

For example:

> **Monzo Homeownership Project Manager helps First-Time Buyers move from uncertainty to completion by guiding each step, coordinating the people involved, explaining complex decisions, and keeping money, documents, and progress safely in one place.**

Then define what it does and does not mean.

It does mean:

- Clear next steps
- Active coordination
- Secure document and payment support
- Decision guidance
- Human help when needed

It does not mean:

- Taking legal responsibility for customer decisions
- Replacing solicitors or advisors entirely
- Adding more admin into the journey
- Becoming just a content hub

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2. Turn the workshop ideas into a prioritised opportunity map and create design concepts

Group ideas by customer pain, differentiation, Monzo right to win, feasibility, and commercial value.

Then create three design concept routes:

- **MVP:** a lightweight command centre with journey stages, next steps, key tasks, document reminders, simple guidance, and human escalation points.
- **Stretch:** a more coordinated experience with conveyancing visibility, smarter nudges, secure sharing, and decision support.
- **Big vision:** a fully managed end-to-end journey combining mortgage, conveyancing, documents, payments, decision support, and post-completion

needs in one Monzo-owned experience.

3. Conduct research on the design concepts listed above

Run research to test whether the MVP, stretch, and big vision concepts match customer needs and willingness to use/pay/trust.

Key questions:

- Do FTBs understand and value the idea of a homebuying Project Manager?
- Which moments feel most valuable for Monzo to manage?
- Where do customers most want human help vs automated guidance?
- How much coordination do they expect Monzo to take on?
- What would make this feel trustworthy rather than overreaching?
- Which features would make them choose Monzo earlier in the journey?

4. Define partner and operating model requirements

Some parts of the proposition depend on partners, data access, integrations, and service design.

Clarify:

- Which services Monzo owns directly
- Which services partners deliver
- What data needs to flow between parties
- What can be automated
- Where human support is required
- What legal/regulatory boundaries exist
- What SLAs or partner expectations are needed

5. Outline a clear execution roadmap

Create a structured 6–12 month roadmap for the product team, showing what should be built, tested, and sequenced across MVP, stretch, and longer-term

opportunities.

⚠️ APPENDIX ⚠️

Key Assumptions

These assumptions are the **key beliefs that came out of our in-depth discussions** throughout the day. They reflect how we think the product, customers, and overall proposition will work, based on what we know so far, but they have not yet been fully tested or proven.

They **help guide our direction and decisions in the short term, and will need to be validated** as we move forward.

🎁 Proposition & Offering

- We will offer a **core mortgage service**, with additional services (like conveyancing and protection) layered on top
- The mortgage broker will be **free**, while other services will have a **clear, fixed price**
- Some services may be delivered by partners, but **Monzo will own and control the overall experience**
- The “Project Manager” should **simplify things for customers**, not add extra steps or repetition

👯 Partnerships & Delivery

- We will use a mix of **partners and in-house solutions** to deliver the full experience
- Some **shared technology** can be used across different services

- Getting involved **early in the journey** can reduce issues, costs, and delays later on

🚀 Customer Behaviour & Value

- First-Time Buyers are more likely to choose an **all-in-one solution**
- They are also more valuable over time, as they may return for future needs (e.g. remortgaging or moving)
- **Word of mouth and referrals** will help drive growth

🤝 Trust, Risk & Responsibility

- We can help customers **better understand complex steps** (like survey results), without taking full responsibility for decisions
- There may be an opportunity to offer **added protection** if a purchase falls through
- Customers need to feel **safe and confident** when sharing sensitive information and moving large amounts of money

Workshop Structure

The session was structured around key stages of the homebuying journey.

1. **Getting Ready**
   Preparing financially, building confidence, and understanding what to expect
2. **Property Search**
   Finding and evaluating properties, and making informed decisions
3. **Making an Offer**
   Submitting and negotiating offers with agents and sellers
4. **Mortgage Application**
   Securing a mortgage and progressing through lender requirements
5. **Conveyancing & Legal**
   Managing legal processes, documentation, and third-party coordination

6. **Exchange of Contracts**
   Finalising agreements and committing to the purchase
7. **Completion Day**
   Transferring funds and completing the transaction
8. **After Completion**
   Settling in, managing follow-ups, and ongoing homeownership needs

What to prioritise

Highest-priority MVP opportunities

1. **Journey command centre**
   - Core progress tracker
   - Next steps
   - Responsibilities
   - Key dates
   - Document and task visibility
2. **FTB affordability and readiness**
   - Affordability confidence
   - Total cost clarity
   - Deposit and savings planning
   - Mortgage in Principle support
3. **Conveyancing visibility**
   - This appears to be one of the most painful and differentiated areas.
   - Focus on legal progress, searches, survey issues, solicitor chasing, and clear explanations.
4. **Secure document and payment moments**
   - Document hub
   - Secure sharing

- Source-of-funds support
- Solicitor bank verification
- Large transfer guidance

5. **Human escalation at high-stress points**
    - Early call
    - Offer stage
    - Survey/legal issues
    - Exchange
    - Completion day

What not to focus on yet

Some ideas are useful but feel more like later-stage enhancements than the strategic core:

- Welcome packs and celebratory gifts (the drill)
- Post-completion planners or rewards
- Removal service booking
- Cashback or introductory offers
- Broad homeownership product cross-sell

These can support the end-to-end experience later, but they are unlikely to prove the Project Manager differentiator by themselves.

IDEAS GENERATED IN WORKSHOP

Getting Ready – Key Ideas from Workshop

1. Affordability & Financial Clarity

- Tools to answer more complex affordability questions (e.g. variable income, parental leave, redundancy risk)

- Clear understanding of **what customers can afford**, including the impact of deposit size
- Exploration of different scenarios (e.g. increasing deposit, changing property type)
- Support for different funding sources (e.g. LISA, Help to Buy, family support)
- A **total cost calculator**, including upfront and hidden costs (e.g. stamp duty)
- Visibility of current market rates and how they are changing

2. Early Guidance & Expert Support

- An **early-stage call** to set expectations and reduce uncertainty
- Automated access to a mortgage advisor and **Mortgage in Principle (DIP)**
- Transcripts and summaries of advice shared back with the customer
- Ongoing check-ins to track progress and re-engage when needed

3. Education & Understanding the Process

- Clear, step-by-step guides to the **end-to-end homebuying journey**
- Explanation of each stage, including roles, timelines, and costs
- Education on key topics (e.g. stamp duty, savings preparation, credit scores)
- Interactive content (e.g. videos, quizzes) to build confidence and understanding
- Guidance on what to consider when starting a property search

4. Planning & Preparation Tools

- Digital checklists of required tasks and documents
- Progress trackers showing journey from affordability → saving → searching
- Tools to help improve financial readiness (e.g. credit score improvement plans)
- Clear expectations of timelines and upcoming steps

5. Trust, Comparison & Decision Support

- Transparent comparison of **costs and value** (e.g. using Monzo vs alternatives)
- Guidance on decisions (e.g. breaking a chain for movers)
- Recommendations for key stakeholders (e.g. conveyancers, surveyors), with clear explanations of their roles
- Access to support for unanswered or complex questions

Property Search – Key Ideas

1. Affordability in Context

- Dynamic cost calculator linked to specific properties
- Real-time validation of affordability (e.g. “can I stretch for this?”), with escalation to a human if needed
- Clear view of how different price points impact monthly payments over time
- Flagging properties that may be outside budget

2. Property Understanding & Evaluation

- Support in understanding potential additional costs (e.g. renovations, repairs, maintenance)
- AI-powered insights on properties (e.g. “what should I ask?”, common risks, things to watch out for)
- Guidance on what to look for during viewings
- Post-viewing summaries or debriefs to help reflect and compare options

3. Organisation & Collaboration

- A shared space to save and manage properties (reducing reliance on scattered links/messages)
- Ability to upload property links and generate summaries or comparisons
- Calendar integration to track and manage viewings (including booking support)
- Personalised tracking of favourite or “target” properties

4. Decision Support & Personalisation

- Tools to analyse preferences based on saved/viewed properties
- AI-generated comparisons between properties and against affordability
- Helping customers navigate the emotional ups and downs of what they can vs can't afford
- Clear trade-offs between different options (e.g. stretching budget vs staying within range)

5. Journey Progression

- Clear checkpoints between stages to guide next steps
- Reinforcing progress and helping customers feel ready to move forward

Making an Offer – Key Ideas

1. Offer Readiness & Affordability

- Prompting customers to secure a **Mortgage in Principle (MIP/DIP)** before making an offer
- Guidance on what they'll be asked for and how to prepare
- Support in deciding what offer to make, including affordability and **LTV considerations**
- Clear view of total and ongoing costs (paid and upcoming), replacing manual tracking

2. Decision Support & Confidence

- Helping customers balance offer price with expected additional costs (e.g. repairs, fees)
- Access to human support for reassurance and next steps
- Simple, jargon-free explanations of what happens after an offer is made

3. Organisation & Process Management

- Ability to log and track offers against specific properties

- Scheduling and managing upcoming steps and appointments
- Automatically updated timelines for key milestones (e.g. exchange and completion)
- Pinning a target property within Monzo to keep it front of mind

4. Team Setup & Coordination

- Guidance on building the right team (e.g. solicitors), including recommendations
- Option to select and connect services directly within the experience
- Clear explanation of roles and responsibilities across stakeholders

5. Documentation & Security

- A centralised document hub for all required paperwork
- Secure sharing of documents with relevant parties
- Clear guidance on fraud prevention and safe communication (e.g. avoiding scams)

6. Payments & Integration

- Preparing for large transactions by connecting relevant accounts in advance
- Making it easy to transfer funds when needed

7. Value & Proposition

- Introducing bundled services and potential perks for using a full “all-in-one” offering
- Early opportunities for upsell into additional services

8. Future-Proofing

- Beginning a “home passport” — a reusable record of the property and transaction for future use

Mortgage Application – Key Ideas

1. Human Support & Guidance

- Access to a **dedicated expert** to guide the application, validate information, and make recommendations
- A clear, upfront call to explain the process in simple terms and set expectations
- Ongoing access to support for questions or reassurance
- “SOS” or **instant help** options (e.g. fast-track to speak to someone when needed)

2. Clarity, Status & Communication

- Regular updates on progress, including **what’s been done and what’s next**
- Visibility into lender timelines (e.g. SLAs, traffic light system)
- Clear communication channels, with an emphasis on secure, in-app messaging

3. Simplifying the Application Process

- Streamlined **fact find** and application flow
- Clear guidance on lender-specific requirements
- Support in gathering and submitting required information

4. Document & Data Management

- Simple upload and management of key documents (e.g. payslips, proof of deposit)
- **One-time data collection** (e.g. ID verification) shared across relevant parties
- Automatic sharing of relevant financial data (e.g. bank statements) where possible
- Centralised storage of property and application documents (“property passport”)

5. Coordination Across Parties

- Ensuring alignment between mortgage advisors, lenders, and solicitors
- Reducing back-and-forth by improving visibility and coordination

6. Reassurance & Decision Support

- Support for moments of doubt (e.g. revisiting decisions, additional checks, further viewings)
- Helping customers feel confident in their choices and next steps

7. Premium Support Opportunities

- Recognising this as a high-intent stage where **enhanced or more hands-on support** (e.g. dedicated case manager) may add value

Conveyancing & Legal – Key Ideas

1. Progress, Coordination & Chasing

- Clear tracking of all conveyancing steps (e.g. searches ordered, reports returned)
- Proactive chasing of solicitors and third parties when tasks are delayed
- Visibility into **who is responsible for what, when, and why**
- Flexible tracking for additional steps (e.g. extra searches, document requests)

2. Communication & Centralisation

- Centralised communication across all parties (reducing scattered emails and messages)
- Support for managing solicitors who may not be fully integrated
- Easy access to calls or chat for specific queries
- Simple appointment booking for key interactions

3. Understanding & Decision Support

- Clear explanations of survey and search results, including **what they mean and what to do next**

- Contextualisation of issues (e.g. how common they are, how serious they might be)
- Guidance on when changes (e.g. renegotiating price) impact the mortgage
- Support in handling “what if things go wrong” scenarios

4. Additional Support & Services

- Access to a directory of experts (e.g. surveyors, builders) for follow-up investigations
- Help sourcing quotes or estimating costs for issues identified
- Guidance on relevant insurance options, including recommendations and costs

5. Document & Data Management

- Central hub for all legal documents, with the ability to view, annotate, and share
- Secure handling of sensitive processes (e.g. source of funds checks, including for third parties like gifters)
- Storage of property legal packs for future use (e.g. remortgaging or selling)

6. Financial Planning & Timing

- Clear timelines for key financial moments (e.g. withdrawing and transferring funds)
- Planning tools to ensure customers are prepared for upcoming payments

7. Reassurance & Emotional Support

- Data-driven reassurance (e.g. how common certain issues are)
- Support during moments of uncertainty or delay
- “SOS” or escalation pathways for urgent help, including human support when needed
- Potential for tracking customer stress and offering proactive support

8. Lifecycle Value

- Opportunities to build long-term value (e.g. reusable property records, future legal perks for remortgaging)

Exchange of Contracts – Key Ideas

1. Payments & Financial Reassurance

- Verification of solicitor bank details to ensure funds are sent to a legitimate account
- Tools to sense-check transfer amounts (e.g. deposit calculations, avoiding input errors)
- Safer payment flows (e.g. pre-filled details, test transfers like sending £1 first)
- Support for coordinating key payments (e.g. deposit transfer, LISA withdrawals, lender fund requests)

2. Coordination & Final Steps

- Managing communication with lenders and advisors to ensure funds are ready on time
- Clear guidance on final steps and timelines leading up to exchange
- Support for any in-person requirements, including optional human assistance

3. Moving Preparation

- Guidance on moving logistics (e.g. typical removal costs)
- Help finding and booking removal services, with flexibility ahead of confirmed dates
- Early planning tools (e.g. furnishing planner to understand what fits in the new home)

4. Documentation & Process

- Simplifying contract signing (e.g. easy or supported “wet signing” where required)

- Ensuring all required documents are completed accurately and on time

5. Reassurance & Support

- Strong focus on reassurance during a high-stress stage
- Clear, proactive communication to reduce uncertainty
- Access to support when needed to avoid customers feeling alone in the process

6. Additional Value

- Timely introduction of relevant products (e.g. home insurance)

Completion Day – Key Ideas

1. Funds & Completion Visibility

- Clear, real-time updates on **movement of funds and chain progress**
- Visibility into settlement status to reduce uncertainty and delays
- Proactive communication if issues arise (e.g. delays in the chain)

2. Support on the Day

- Check-ins to ensure everything is progressing as expected
- Support for resolving any last-minute issues or questions

3. Celebration & Experience

- Marking the moment with **celebratory touches** (e.g. welcome or congratulations pack)
- Branded elements to create a memorable experience (e.g. house-themed gifts)

4. Closing the Journey

- Clear signal that the **“project” phase is complete**
- Smooth handover from buying journey to ongoing homeownership

After Completion – Key Ideas

1. Ongoing Support & Check-ins

- Post-completion check-ins to ensure everything has gone smoothly
- Follow-up surveys to capture reflections (e.g. “what do you wish you’d known?”)
- Continued access to support for any issues or questions

2. Homeownership Management

- Ongoing management of key products (e.g. hom insurance, protection, emergency cover)
- Easy access to important documents and information in one place
- Reminders and prompts for important future events

3. Long-Term Engagement

- Proactive reminders for **remortgaging** at the right time
- Transition into the next stage of the lifecycle (e.g. remortgage or next purchase)

4. Value & Incentives

- Exploration of additional benefits (e.g. cashback, introductory offers)
- Potential financial flexibility (e.g. early repayment support or introductory offers, subject to viability)

5. Celebration & Brand Experience

- Reinforcing the moment with **post-move rewards or welcome packs**
- Creating a memorable, branded experience for customers who use the full service

Early Concepts & Opportunity Areas

Ahead of ideation, a set of initial concepts and ideas were captured based on known customer needs and pain points. These have been grouped into key themes to highlight common patterns and areas of opportunity.

1. Progress, Visibility & Coordination

- A central progress view showing key stages of the journey
- Step-level “progress hubs” with visibility across different stakeholders
- Clear indication of who is responsible for what
- Highlighting what needs attention now vs later
- Creating a guided path from the very beginning

2. Understanding & Decision Support

- Translating complex reports (e.g. surveys) into simple, clear language (including AI summaries)
- Providing context on issues (e.g. “is this common?” with benchmarks or social proof)
- Suggesting next steps, including auto-generated follow-up questions to third parties
- Supplementing information with videos and interactive learning (e.g. quizzes)

3. Communication & Automation

- Automating follow-ups with stakeholders while keeping the customer informed
- Supporting easier coordination across multiple parties
- Helping customers choose and manage suppliers

4. Documentation & Information Management

- A “passport” or central hub to store everything related to the property and transaction

- Reducing fragmentation of documents and information across the journey

5. Financial Preparedness & Transparency

- Setting expectations upfront on costs, including commonly missed expenses
- Showing typical spend at each stage of the process
- Helping users plan and prepare for large transactions (e.g. transfer limits, timing)

6. Trust, Security & Reassurance

- Increasing confidence when handling large sums of money (e.g. high-value transfers)
- Reinforcing a sense of security when sharing sensitive data
- Using social proof to reassure customers in uncertain moments

7. Emotional Experience

- Designing for emotional moments in the journey (e.g. reducing anxiety, creating moments of relief or reassurance)
- Drawing on patterns from other domains (e.g. “take a breath” moments in high-stress flows)

These themes highlight early directions for exploration and helped inform more structured ideation during the session.

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